instance, *kulapati* (householder) was an insult used to chastise a monk whose acts or thoughts deviated from the renunciatory ideal.

Whereas Tantrism, besides valuing non-dualism, spiritual growth and the union of one's atman with Brahman, also valued worldly success. It saw spiritual growth as compatible *and* intertwined with success in love, rather than as opposites. The Tantrics' methods for achieving their goals differed too. In *The Roots of Tantra*, Robert L. Brown writes that Tantric practitioners reach these dual goals 'by connecting themselves to a power that flows through the world, including their own bodies, a power usually visualized as female'. He adds that 'the ultimate tool in Tantra is the human body . . . both the anatomical body of arms, hands, tongue, heart, genitals, and mind, and the yogic anatomy of *cakras* and *nadis*. It is control of the body as a tool used to actuate processes that connect the practitioner with the universal power to reach his goals'.

Or as a modern practitioner in Assam put it, 'Tantra is mind and body together, the whole human being in spiritual practice.'[38] Hindu Tantrics seek to unite two poles of reality, imagined by them as Shiva and Shakti, male and female, both present in every human body. Their union produces absolute bliss and is attained through disciplined kundalini yoga and often with added sexual practices, the goal of which is not hedonism but a higher state of awakening. Other broad characteristics of Tantra include relatively 'less stress on mythology and narrative stories of deities, less stress on love of god [as in devotional Hinduism], less stress on moral action (for Buddhism), [and] less stress on temple worship and priests'.[39]

Alternatively, 'Tantra could be defined as a means of harnessing *kama*', where Kama is seen as a lot more than sexual desire and includes 'longing, love, affection, object of desire, pleasure, enjoyment, sexual love, sensuality'[40] and more. Tantra then 'is the path that seeks to harness, transform, and redirect *kama* toward the aims of both this-worldly power and spiritual liberation'.[41] The mere sating of kama is not the end, but a means to the end of transcending kama itself. 'Not primarily a means to pleasure alone, *kama* is rather a means to awaken and channel the tremendous energy that lies within the body and the cosmos.'[42]